Margaret Thatcher and Chancellor Helmut Schmidt in Bonn, 17 November 1980

28. By this point, Honecker had established a ‘balance of payments working group’ to watch over the use of the scarce foreign currency on a weekly basis.

29. Reagan. ‘The President’s News Conference,’ 16 June 1981.

30. Decades later, Jaruzelski rather bizarrely admitted that the worst part of his job had been to kiss Honecker. ‘He had this disgusting way of kissing,’ he sniffed. The fraternal kiss became famous after Honecker and Brezhnev were photographed exercising the ritual, the image was subsequently reproduced into a graffiti painting on the Berlin Wall with the slogan: ‘My God, Help Me to Survive This Deadly Love.’

Do svidaniya Brezhnev

1. Honecker Cross Examined . p.40

2. In 2007, Der Spiegel reported Honecker was not upset by the incident and was said to have shot nine deer with a steady hand later that same day.

3. Neues Deutschland . 31 December 1982

4. Westfalen Blatt. 21 April 1983

5. Der Spiegel . 24 April 1983

6. Pravda . 27 April 1983

7. Die Erinnerungen , Strauss memoirs. Pantheon Verlag, 2015. p.25

8. Daily Report. FBIS-WEU-83-158-A